



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Chesterton Academy of the Holy Family
School Website: <https://www.chestertonacademyoftheholysfamily.com/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Chesterton Academy of the Holy Family (CATHF) presents a coherent, clearly Catholic, and classical program that aligns strongly with the core tenets of the classical education rubric. Public-facing materials emphasize a joyful, liturgical, and faith-infused education rooted in the Catholic tradition, with explicit commitments to daily Mass, formation in virtue, and exposure to liberal-arts breadth through a classical curriculum. The school describes its mission as forming virtuous leaders and saints within a culture of life, educated in the classical tradition and grounded in Catholic truth. This is reinforced by references to daily Mass, a chaplain, alignment with the Diocese, and a curricular emphasis on the liberal arts and the Great Books tradition. In short, the school signals a robust alignment with Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, Curriculum, and Purpose/Goal, with compelling elements in Pedagogy (Socratic-like dialogue, memorial/recitation practices), Faculty (teacher-mentors and living examples), and Parents & Community (strong parental partnership and community involvement).

Key strengths - Explicit Catholic identity and liturgical life (Mass, chaplain, diocese affiliation) deeply embedded in daily life and mission. This is supported by statements that the school is "a Joyfully Catholic, Classical High School" and that Mass is central to the day.

- Curriculum framed through a classical, liberal-arts paradigm with emphasis on Great Books, Western thought, and formation in virtue within a Catholic framework. Evidence includes "a rigorous, integrated and classical curriculum taught through the lens of the Catholic faith," and explicit cues to the Great Books/Western thought orientation.
- Pedagogical approach integrates Socratic-style inquiry and rhetoric within a framework that also honors liturgical, contemplative, and memory-based practices. The presence of a dedicated "Socratic Seminar" in the school materials signals alignment with classical pedagogy.
- Strong home-school partnership and parental involvement as core to the model (Cultiva Vitae, family involvement, affordability supported by parent participation).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Catholic identity, liturgical life, daily Mass, diocese affiliation, and theology-infused curriculum.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords identified include Catholic, Mass, liturgy, theology, Incarnation, and sacred tradition; negligible to no negative religious-secular signals detected. Estimated positive keyword presence dominates (roughly 6–8 clear matches across sources) with 0 detectable negative signals in the materials cited. This yields a CLASSICAL rating.
 - Why this rating: The materials squarely affirm transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) embedded in a liturgical, theological frame; communal worship and sacramental life are woven into daily life.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Mission to form virtuous leaders and saints; Cultura Vitae; liberal-arts orientation;

emphasis on virtue and human flourishing rather than mere job preparation.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include formation, virtue, liberal education, and pursuit of truth/beauty; limited to no explicit workforce-formation language in the public materials (some mention of college/professional life in the mission but within a formation frame). Estimated positive keyword presence outpaces negative by a clear margin; resulting in CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating: The materials foreground formation and virtue as the telos of education, with truth/goodness/beauty real and knowable, aligned with the classical-pedagogical aim.
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Classical curriculum framing, liberal-arts emphasis, Great Books/Western thought orientation, and the interrelationship of great ideas. Also references to the Great Books and a broad liberal-arts education.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include liberal arts, Great Books, grammar/logic/rhetoric (Trivium), and the Great Conversation; presence of these terms in the site materials supports a CLASSICAL rating. Some materials reference a Great Books orientation without always using the exact phrase “Great Conversation,” but the overall sense is strongly classical. Negative candidates (e.g., project-based learning-dominant framing, social-studies replacements, etc.) do not appear in the Chesterton Holy Family public materials; thus, negative keywords are minimal. Overall, CLASSICAL.
 - Why this rating: The curriculum is presented through a classical-liberal-arts lens with explicit emphasis on the Great Books and Western canon, aligned with the Six Essential Elements’ curricular criteria.
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Socratic-style inquiry identified in materials (Socratic Seminar), rhythm of memory and recitation, and the integration of liturgical and contemplative practices. The published materials explicitly reference a “Socratic Seminar” and “The Socratic Seminar” as a teaching tool; there are notes on memory work and ritual, consistent with Scholé concepts.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include Socratic seminar, dialectic, recitation, chanting, and restful learning (Scholé); these features appear explicitly in the sources. Negative signals (e.g., exclusive reliance on project-based or constructivist-only approaches) are not evident in the public-facing materials. Frequency indicates notable alignment with classical pedagogy. CLASSICAL.
 - Why this rating: The school’s pedagogy blends Socratic discourse with memory-driven and liturgically-infused practices, which matches the classical pedagogy signals.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: The school emphasizes faculty as virtue-models and mentors, living the curriculum, and fostering a collegial, mentorship-driven culture. The open-house/orientation materials describe student life leadership and faculty involvement in house systems and formation, with references to teachers and staff in leadership/formation roles; the school is described as a community of teachers who model virtue and wisdom.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include mentors, living curriculum, virtuous teachers, and missionary-stewardship language. While explicit phraseology like “portrait of what a teacher should be” is not abundantly quoted in the public pages, the materials present teachers as central to school culture and student formation (e.g., daily Mass, chaplaincy, leadership alignment). Negative signals are not observed. CLASSICAL.
 - Why this rating: The teacher as moral exemplar and the living-curriculum framing align with classical criteria for faculty. The public materials portray teachers as core to formation and culture.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Partnership with families and the Church; active parent involvement and outreach; affordability tied to parental engagement; prominent parent participation in events and governance; community life visible through events like the Fleur-de-Lis Gala and family-facing communications.

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- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, family involvement, and open-campus hospitality. The materials also emphasize the importance of parental volunteering and engagement in fundraising and governance. No negative signals observed in public materials. CLASSICAL.
 - Why this rating: The school explicitly treats parents as co-educators and highlights extensive parental involvement, formation opportunities for parents, and open access to the campus for visits.

Aggregate assessment - All six categories are CLASSICAL, based on explicit textual cues within the Chesterton Academy of the Holy Family materials and the classical-learning framework in the knowledge documents. The consistent emphasis on Catholic liturgy, virtue formation, Great Books/liberal-arts curriculum, Socratic and contemplative pedagogy, teacher as living exemplar, and robust parent/community partnership strongly supports a CLASSICAL designation.

What would move the needle (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL section) - Not applicable: The aggregate rating is CLASSICAL, and no category requires a needle-moving change to reach a more classical posture.

WHAT WOULD MOVE THE NEEDLE

- N/A (The school is classified as CLASSICAL; no required needle-moving changes are indicated by the category-by-category keyword analysis.)

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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